

Verta — shared electric fleets for urban logistics

The Problem

A delivery company operating 60 vans in a European city faces an electrification deadline it cannot meet economically. Electric vans cost 40% more to buy, charging infrastructure requires a depot upgrade the landlord will not fund, and utilisation is 54% — the vehicles sit idle two days a week while the finance charge runs every day.

Buying assets that idle half the time made sense when the assets were cheap. At electric prices it stops making sense.

Our Solution

Verta operates shared electric van fleets from depots with charging built in, and rents capacity by the day.

A logistics operator books eighteen vans for Monday to Thursday and pays for four days. A grocery delivery service takes twelve of the same vans at the weekend. The vehicles run at 80% utilisation rather than 54%, and the charging infrastructure is amortised across every operator using the depot rather than sitting on one balance sheet.

We handle maintenance, charging, insurance and compliance. The operator gets a vehicle with a charged battery at 6am and nothing else to think about.

The Market

Urban commercial vehicle fleets in Western Europe number around 4.2 million. Electrification mandates are already law in eleven cities we have mapped, with deadlines between 2027 and 2030.

Our addressable segment is operators with 20 to 200 vehicles — too large for retail leasing, too small to finance a depot. That is roughly 31,000 operators.

Competition

Traditional leasing companies offer electric vans but not shared utilisation or charging, which leaves the depot problem with the customer. Two van-sharing startups exist, both operating rental models without dedicated depot infrastructure.

Our position rests on owning the depot and the charging, which is capital-intensive and slow — a genuine barrier and a genuine risk.

The Team

Katarina Novak spent ten years in fleet operations, the last four running a 900-vehicle commercial fleet across four countries, including its first electrification pilot. Rasmus Dahl founded and sold a depot management software company, and led charging infrastructure deployment at a European energy group.

This is the strongest fleet electrification team we could have assembled, and it is the reason we believe we can execute something this operationally heavy.

Twenty-nine people, eleven of them in depot operations.

Traction

- first depot open in Rotterdam since June, 40 vans
- second depot secured in Lyon, opening in the spring
- eleven operators have signed letters of intent
- three operators are running paid trials

We are early. We do not yet have repeat bookings across a full quarter, and we cannot yet show what utilisation looks like once a depot is at capacity rather than at launch. Those are the numbers that will decide whether this works, and we do not have them.

Business Model

Daily rate per vehicle, from €68 to €94 depending on commitment length. A depot at 80% utilisation across 60 vehicles returns roughly €1.4M a year against €310,000 of operating cost and the amortised depot build.

The model is straightforward. Whether utilisation reaches 80% in practice is the entire question.

Go-To-Market

Direct sales to fleet managers, with cities as a second channel: three municipalities have introduced us to operators facing their own mandates.

Funding

We are raising €22M to open four depots, reach the density where cross-operator sharing works, and prove the utilisation thesis on a full year of data.